

Palau International Ship Registry



Head Office
Piraeus, 18536, Greece
5, Sachtouri Street, 6th floor
T: +30 210 4293500
F: +30 210 4293505
info@palaureg.com
www.palaureg.com

MARINE CIRCULAR 188.2

To: ALL SHIPOWNERS, MANAGERS, MASTERS, AND REGISTRATION OFFICERS OF MERCHANT SHIPS AND RECOGNIZED ORGANIZATIONS.

Subject: PLEASURE (PRIVATE) YACHTS OF LESS THAN 500 GT WITH LIMITED CHARTER ALLOWANCE

1. Purpose

- 1.1 The purpose of this Marine Circular is to inform owners, managing companies, Deputy Registrars, Masters and Recognized Organizations on the procedures to follow in order to obtain Limited Charter Allowance for Pleasure Vessels of less than 500 GT.
- 1.2 This Marine Circular also provides guidance on the technical requirements for pleasure vessels that obtain Limited Charter Allowance.

2. General Information

- 2.1 Pleasure yachts (yacht not engaged on commercial trade), up to 500 gross tonnage may be chartered out under certain conditions for 3 months / 90 days in a calendar year, with a maximum of twelve (12) passengers.
- 2.2 Pleasure Yacht which use a limited charter allowance privilege will be exempted from the requirements to register the yacht as a commercial yacht.
- 2.3 The registered owner or the Deputy Registrar will have to submit a [Declaration of a Pleasure Yacht With Limited Charter Allowance \(F.052\)](#) to the Palau Ship Registry Administrator for any yacht which intends to use the limited charter allowance privilege. To ensure timely processing, such declaration should reach the Palau Ship Registry Administrator at least one (1) week prior to the start date of the charter.

3. Restriction on Operations

- 3.1 Pleasure yachts are not permitted to undertake charters in Palau territorial waters. (This Circular applies to pleasure yachts operating outside Palau's waters.)
- 3.2 The Owner and Master should ensure that a limited charter allowance privilege is accepted by the local authorities where the yacht is intended to trade.

4. Small Pleasure Yacht (Below 24 meters in Load Line Length)

- 4.1 Ship Owners and Managers of small pleasure yachts who wish to use the limited charter allowance privilege should ensure that their yachts are in compliance with



Palau International Ship Registry



Head Office
Piraeus, 18536, Greece
5, Sachtour Street, 6th floor
T: +30 210 4293500
F: +30 210 4293505
info@palaureg.com
www.palaureg.com

the [Palau Pleasure Safety Code](#), as amended. They should also meet with the following requirements of the [Palau Commercial Safety Code](#), as amended.

Section 15 - Life-Saving Appliances,
Section 16 - Fire Safety
Section 19 - Safety of Navigation
Section 20 – Navigation Lights, Shapes, and Sound Signals; and
Section 21 – Radio Equipment

- 4.2 Yachts should be inspected every five years by an Authorized Surveyor or Recognized Organization in order to verify the compliance with the above-mentioned requirements.
- 4.3 Upon the yacht's successful survey, the Recognized Organization will be authorized to issue an Interim Document of Compliance for Pleasure Yacht with Limited Charter Allowance valid for six (6) months. The Palau Ship Registry Administrator will issue the permanent Document of Compliance for Pleasure Yacht with Limited Charter Allowance valid for five (5) years from the date of survey subject to the annual owner's declaration of compliance through a checklist and the insurance coverage confirmation.
- 4.4 A Minimum Safe Manning Document is not compulsory for small pleasure yachts. However, the Master should hold a Certificate of Competence or license issued either by his national State or by the State where he has his permanent residence, or recognized by the Palau Ship Registry Administrator and should be appropriate for the yacht's size, navigational area, and category.

5. Pleasure Yacht of 24 meters and over up to 500 GT

- 5.1 The Owners, who wish to charter their pleasure yacht of 24 m and above, in accordance with the limited charter allowance, will have to satisfy additional requirements which are not imposed on yachts which are purely intended for private use.
- 5.2 Pleasure yachts of 24 m and above which use a limited charter allowance should be in compliance with the [Palau Pleasure Yacht Safety Code](#). They should also meet with the following requirements of the [Palau Commercial Yacht Code](#).

Section 15 - Life-Saving Appliances,
Section 16 - Fire-Fighting Equipment
Section 19 - Safety of Navigation
Section 20 – Navigation Lights, Shapes, and Sound Signals; and
Section 21 – Radio Communication Equipment
Annex IV – Manning



Palau International Ship Registry



Head Office
Piraeus, 18536, Greece
5, Sachtoura Street, 6th floor
T: +30 210 4293500
F: +30 210 4293505
info@palaureg.com
www.palaureg.com

Minimum Safe Manning Certificate is compulsory for yachts of 24 m and over. Safety manning requirements should be in accordance with Annex IV of the [Palau Commercial Yacht Code](#).

- 5.3 These yachts should be inspected annually by an Authorized Surveyor or Recognized Organization to verify the compliance with the above-mentioned requirements.
- 5.4 Upon the yacht's successful survey, the Recognized Organization will be authorized to issue an Interim Document of Compliance for Pleasure Yacht with Limited Charter Allowance valid for six (6) months. The Palau Ship Registry Administrator will issue the permanent Document of Compliance for Pleasure Yacht with Limited Charter Allowance valid for five (5) years subject to the annual survey by an Authorized Surveyor or Recognized Organization.
- 5.5 The owner will contact the Palau Ship Registry Administrator's Registration Office in order to start the process of application to obtain the Certificate of Registry with Limited Charter Allowance.
- 5.6 This Administration will issue the Certificate of Registry with Limited Charter Allowance valid for its registration time (one, three or five years).

6. Maintenance of Records

- 6.1 During the period in which a pleasure yacht is engaged in a limited charter allowance, its status will change from pleasure to commercial operation. This change in status must be fully documented and verifiable. These records may be examined by a Palau appointed Flag Inspector or by a Recognized Organization and may be requested by an attending Port State Control Inspector or any appropriate port official as evidence of compliance with this Circular.
- 6.2 Pleasure Yachts which change status to Limited Charter during a calendar year should record such changes in the yacht's Deck Logbook for each period that the yacht is engaged in limited charter or for private use only. It is the Master's and the Owner's responsibility not to exceed the charter allowance of 3 months / 90 days.
- 6.3 The Owner/Master should immediately inform the Palau Ship Registry Administrator whenever the yacht is engaged in limited charter i.e. when the yacht enters and terminates the limited charter. Such notification should be received within two days of the change of status.



Palau International Ship Registry



Head Office
Piraeus, 18536, Greece
5, Sachtour Street, 6th floor
T: +30 210 4293500
F: +30 210 4293505
info@palaureg.com
www.palaureg.com

6.4 The requested certificates and other documentation for pleasure yacht up to 500 GT with or without limited charter allowance are shown in the Annex.

7. Annexes to this Circulars

7.1 Annex I: CERTIFICATES AND OTHER DOCUMENTATION REQUIRED FOR PLEASURE YACHT UP TO 500 GT WITH AND WITHOUT LIMITED CHARTER ALLOWANCE

7.2 Annex II: DECLARATION OF THE OWNER OF PLEASURE YACHT WITH LIMITED CHARTER ALLOWANCE

8. Contact

8.1 Any inquiries concerning the subject for this Marine Circular should be directed to the Palau Ship Registry Administrator at technical@palaureg.com

This Marine Circular supersedes
the MC 188.1

Click [here](#) or use the below QR
Code for the list of the last updated
Marine Circular



Annex I

CERTIFICATES AND OTHER DOCUMENTATION REQUIRED FOR PLEASURE YACHT UP TO 500 GT WITH AND WITHOUT LIMITED CHARTER ALLOWANCE

Certificate/Document	Issuing Body	Small Pleasure Yachts below 24 m in Load Line Length		Pleasure Yachts of 24 m and over up to 500 GT	
		Pleasure Yachts	Pleasure yachts with limited charter allowance	Pleasure Yachts	Pleasure yachts with limited charter allowance
Pleasure Yacht Certificate of Registry	Flag	X	X	X	X
Ship Station Licence	Flag	X	X	X	X
Tonnage Certificate	Flag/RO	X	X	-	-
International Tonnage Certificate	Flag/RO	-	-	X	X
Minimum Safe Manning Document	Flag	-	-	-	X
Pleasure Yacht Document of Compliance	Flag	X	-	X	-
Pleasure Yacht Certificate of Registry with limited Charter Allowance	Flag	-	X	-	X
Declaration of the Owner (Pleasure Yacht with limited Charter Allowance)	Owner	-	X	-	-
International Oil Pollution Prevention Certificate (for yachts of 400 GT or over)	RO	X	X	X	X
International Air Pollution Prevention Certificate (for yachts of 400 GT or over)	RO	X	X	X	X
International Sewage Pollution Prevention Certificate (for yachts of 400 GT or over or yachts less than 400 GT carrying more than 15 persons)	RO	X	X	X	X
Garbage Management Plan and Record Book (for yachts of 400 GT or more or carrying more than 15 persons)	Owner	X	X	X	X
Statement of Compliance with Antifouling Systems	RO	-	-	X	X
International Ballast Water Management Statement of Compliance (for yachts of 400 GT or over). <i>*For other yachts, please refer to the Pleasure Yacht Safety Code, Section 16)</i>	RO	-*	-*	X*	X*

Palau International Ship Registry



Head Office
Piraeus, 18536, Greece
5, Sachtouris Street, 6th floor
T: +30 210 4293500
F: +30 210 4293505
info@palaureg.com
www.palaureg.com

Annex II

Declaration of the Owner of a Pleasure Yacht with limited Charter Allowance

Owner/Owner's Representative: (Company's Name and Address)				
Yacht's Name:				
Official Number:				
Date of last Survey for the Document of Compliance for Pleasure Yacht with Limited Charter Allowance	(select as appropriate and indicate the date):			
	Initial	☐	Renewal	☐
	Date:		Date:	

Please be advised that the above-mentioned motor/sailing yacht continues to be maintained in a good and safe operating condition, maintains the level of seaworthiness including sufficient life-saving and fire fighting equipment on board and overall maintenance for the safety of its crew and passengers and that it complies with the Palau Pleasure Yacht Safety Code and Palau Commercial Yacht Safety Code in order to maintain the Certificate of Registry With Limited Charter Allowance.

Place and Date:	
Print Name and Capacity:	

